Dayeon (Zoey) Ki

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Ph.D. Candidate at UMD CLIP Lab

Research Interests

I study how to make language models better **communicative tools** for people from diverse linguistic and cultural backgrounds, who bring their own communicative norms and face distinct communication barriers.
My research lies at the intersection of **human-centered AI** and **multilingual, multicultural NLP**. I combine machine learning methods with human-subject studies to (1) audit how models represent knowledge, express value commitments, and reason in interaction, (2) design interactions that help people build shared understanding and exercise informed agency, and (3) study how AI-mediated communication shapes social interaction and relationships over time.
I envision models that helps people *understand* and *be understood*, assess the grounds and limits of what they're told, and participate without having their perspectives discounted.

Education

2023 –	**Ph.D.**, Computer Science, **University of Maryland**
2023 – 25	**M.Sc.**, Computer Science, **University of Maryland**
2019 – 23	**B.Sc.**, Statistics & Computer Science, **Korea University** (*Summa Cum Laude*)
2016 – 18	International School of Prague

Research Experience

2023 –	Research Assistant, CLIP Lab, **University of Maryland** (Advisor: Marine Carpuat)
2023	Visiting Scholar, **Johns Hopkins University** (Advisor: Kevin Duh)
2022 – 23	Undergraduate Researcher, LK Lab, **KAIST** (Advisor: Minjoon Seo)
2022	Undergraduate Researcher, DAVIAN Lab, **KAIST** (Advisor: Jaegul Choo)

Publications

🎓 Google Scholar
* : Equal contribution

Selected Publication

[P5] Where's Waldo? Query-language Preference Under Cross-lingual Knowledge Disparities
Dayeon Ki, Ruochen Zhang, Silviu Cucerzan, Ryen W White, Ning Gao
Under Review (ICLR 2027)

[C13] **The AI Observatory: A Public Measure of Real-World AI Use** [Website]
Shayne Longpre*, Anka Reuel*, Dayeon Ki*, Cathy Mengying Fang, Megan Richards, Zhiping Zhang, Chuanyang Jin, Jenn Mickel, Cedric Deslandes Whitney, Ahmet Üstün, Niloofar Mireshghallah, Victor Ojewale, Ariel Lee, Alex (Sandy) Pentland, Tianshi Li, Yuntian Deng, Mykel Kochenderfer, Sara Hooker, Sanmi Koyejo
The Fortieth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, ***NeurIPS E&D 2026***

[C12] **AdaMame: A Training Recipe for Adaptive Multilingual Reasoning**
Dayeon Ki, Kevin Duh, Marine Carpuat
The 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, ***EMNLP 2026***

[C11+W8] **What Makes Good Multilingual Reasoning? Disentangling Reasoning Traces with Measurable Features**
Dayeon Ki, Kevin Duh, Marine Carpuat
Third Conference On Language Modeling, ***COLM 2026***
The 1st Workshop on Multilinguality in the Era of Large Language Models, ***ACL MeLLM 2026***

[C10] **Linguistic Nepotism: Trading-off Quality for Language Preference in Multilingual RAG**
Dayeon Ki, Marine Carpuat, Paul McNamee, Daniel Khashabi, Eugene Yang, Dawn Lawrie, Kevin Duh
Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning, ***ICML 2026***
🏆 **Spotlight (*top 2.2%*)**

[C9+W7] **Reheat Nachos for Dinner? Evaluating AI Support for Cross-Cultural Communication of Neologisms**
Dayeon Ki*, Yu Hou*, Rachel Rudinger, Hal Daumé III, Marine Carpuat, Fumeng Yang
The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics, ***ACL Findings 2026***
4th Workshop on Cross-Cultural Considerations in NLP Workshop, ***ACL C3NLP 2026***

[C8+W6] **Should I Share this Translation? Evaluating Quality Feedback for User Reliance on Machine Translation**
Dayeon Ki, Kevin Duh, Marine Carpuat
The 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, ***EMNLP 2025***
4th Bridging Human-Computer Interaction and Natural Language Processing Workshop, ***EMNLP HCI+NLP 2025***

[C7] **AskQE: Question Answering as Automatic Evaluation for Machine Translation**
Dayeon Ki, Kevin Duh, Marine Carpuat
The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics, ***ACL Findings 2025***

[C6] **Multi-LLM Agents Debate for Equitable Cultural Alignment**
Dayeon Ki, Rachel Rudinger, Tianyi Zhou, Marine Carpuat
The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics, ***ACL 2025***
🏆 **Oral (*top 8%*)**

[C5] **Automatic Input Rewriting Improves Translation with Large Language Models**
Dayeon Ki, Marine Carpuat

2025 Annual Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics, ***NAACL 2025***

[C4] Guiding Large Language Models to Post-Edit Machine Translation with Error Annotations
Dayeon Ki, Marine Carpuat
2024 Annual Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics, ***NAACL Findings 2024***

Publication

[P4] Grounding in AI-Mediated Human Communication: Evidence from Speech Recognition and Translation
Calvin Bao, **Dayeon Ki**, Srija Anand, Ge Gao, Kevin Duh, Marine Carpuat
Under Review (TACL 2026)

[P3] Pragmatics Meets Culture: Culturally-adapted Artwork Description Generation and Evaluation
Lingjun Zhao, **Dayeon Ki**, Marine Carpuat, Hal Daumé III
Under Review (NAACL 2027)

[W5] Towards Trustworthy AI-Mediated Communication Across Languages and Cultures
Dayeon Ki
The Big Picture 2026: Crafting a Research Narrative v2 Workshop, ***ACL Big Picture 2026***

[W4] GraphicWeaver: Benchmarking Agentic Planning for Graphic Design Generation
Dayeon Ki, Tianyi Zhou, Marine Carpuat, Gang Wu, Puneet Mathur, Viswanathan Swaminathan
4th Workshop on Advances in Language and Vision Research, ***ACL ALVR 2026***

[C3] When AI Benchmarks Plateau: A Systematic Study of Benchmark Saturation
Mubashara Akhtar, Anka Reuel, Prajna Soni, Sanchit Ahuja, Pawan Sasanka Ammanamanchi, Ruchit Rawal, Vilém Zouhar, Srishti Yadav, Chenxi Whitehouse, **Dayeon Ki**, Jennifer Mickel, Leshem Choshen, Marek Šuppa, Jan Batzner, Jenny Chim, Jeba Sania, Yanan Long, Hossein A. Rahmani, Christina Knight, Yiyang Nan, Jyoutir Raj, Yu Fan, Shubham Singh, Subramanyam Sahoo, Eliya Habba, Usman Gohar, Siddhesh Pawar, Robert Scholz, Arjun Subramonian, Jingwei Ni, Mykel Kochenderfer, Sanmi Koyejo, Mrinmaya Sachan, Stella Biderman, Zeerak Talat, Avijit Ghosh, Irene Solaiman
Forty-Third International Conference on Machine Learning, ***ICML 2026***

[P2] In the Shadow of Judgment: Mapping Out the Landscape of Human-AI Decision-Making Through a Systematic Review
Yixin Bai, Taehyun Yang, Zhongzheng Xu, **Dayeon Ki**, Ziyi Wang, Yu Hou, Fumeng Yang
Preprint

[C2] Toward Machine Translation Literacy: How Lay Users Perceive and Rely on Imperfect Translations
Yimin Xiao, Yongle Zhang, **Dayeon Ki**, Calvin Bao, Marianna Martindale, Charlotte Vaughn, Ge Gao, Marine Carpuat

The 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, ***EMNLP 2025***

[W3] Can They Dixit? Yes they Can! Dixit as a Playground for Multimodal Language Model Capabilities
Nishant Balepur, Dang Nguyen, **Dayeon Ki**
Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop, ***EMNLP WordPlay 2025***
🏆 **Spotlight**

[P1] The Prompt Report: A Systematic Survey of Prompt Engineering Techniques
Sander Schulhoff, [...], **Dayeon Ki**, [...]
Preprint

[W2] Cross-lingual QA: A Key to Unlocking In-context Cross-lingual Performance
Sunkyoung Kim*, **Dayeon Ki***, Yireun Kim, Jinsik Lee
1st ICML Workshop on In-Context Learning, ***ICML ICL 2024***

[W1] Mitigating Semantic Leakage in Cross-lingual Embeddings via Orthogonality Constraint
Dayeon Ki, Hyunjoong Kim, Cheonbok Park
9th Workshop on Representation Learning for NLP, ***ACL RepL4NLP 2024***

[I1] An Integrated Search System for Korea Weather Data
Jinkyung Jo, **Dayeon Ki**, Soyoung Yoon, Minjoon Seo
The 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, ***EMNLP Industry 2023***

[C1] Towards Accurate Translation via Semantically Appropriate Application of Lexical Constraints
Yujin Baek*, Koanho Lee*, **Dayeon Ki**, Hyoung-Gyu Lee, Cheonbok Park, Jaegul Choo
The 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics, ***ACL Findings 2023***

Industry Experience

2026/06 – 2026/08	Research Intern, Applied Sciences, **Microsoft** (Mentor: Ning Gao, Silviu Cucerzan, Ruochen Zhang)
2024/05 – 2024/12	Research Scientist Intern, Document Intelligence Lab, **Adobe Research** (Mentor: Puneet Mathur, Gang Wu, Viswanathan Swaminathan)
2023/01 – 2023/06	Research Intern, Papago, **NAVER Cloud** (Mentor: Hyunjoong Kim, Cheonbok Park)
2022/08 – 2022/12	Research Intern, EXAONE Lab, **LG AI Research** (Mentor: Sunkyoung Kim)
2020/08 – 2021/12	Co-Founder & Software Engineer, **Da-Chae**

Awards & Honors

2026/05	Financial Aid Award, ICML 2026 (*$2,100*)
2026/05	Gold Reviewer (top 25%), ICML 2026 (*$425*)
2026/05	Catalyst Grant, Cohere Labs (*$500*)
2025 – 26	Outstanding Graduate Assistant Award, University of Maryland (*$375*)
2025/07	Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland (*$600*)
2025/07	International Conference Student Support Award, University of Maryland (*$500*)
2023 – 25	Dean's Scholarship, Department of Computer Science, University of Maryland (*$5,000*)
2022	Dean's List Scholarship, Department of Statistics, Korea University (*$1,300*)
2021/08	Finalist, Capstone Datathon, Korea University
2021/06	Best Teaching Mentor, Korea University
2020/10	Runner-up, Seoul Entrepreneurship Competition (*$700*)
2020/08	Runner-up, Korea Artificial Intelligence
2016 – 17	Math Representative, University of Waterloo

Academic Service

2026	Area Chair, Interpreting Agent Behavior (IAB) Workshop (NeurIPS 2026)
2026 – 27	Co-Chair, Student Research Workshop (NACCL SRW 2027)
2026	Judge, LSURF (*Louis Stokes Undergraduate Research Fellows*) Symposium 2026
2023 –	Student Affiliate Member, TRAILS (*The Institute of Trustworthy AI in Law & Society*)
2026 – 27	Reviewer (ICLR)
2026	Reviewer (AAAI, NeurIPS)
2025 – 26	Reviewer (COLM)
2025	Program Committee (EMNLP HCI+NLP)
2024, 26	Reviewer (ICML)
2023 –	Reviewer (ARR)
2023 – 24	Graduate Admission Committee, University of Maryland
2022 –	Student Volunteer (AACL 2022, COLING 2022, UMD CS Visit Day 2023–24, NAACL 2025, AIM Research & Learning Symposium 2026, HCOMP+CI 2026)

Invited Talks

2026/08	*Whose Knowledge, Whose Values, Whose Reasoning? Auditing Multilingual Bias Across the Model Pipeline*, **University of British Columbia** (Host: Vered Shwartz)
2026/07	*Linguistic Nepotism: Trading-off Quality for Language Preference in Multilingual RAG*, **Microsoft ODSP Applied Sciences Reading Group**
2025/09	*Empowering Reliable Use of Machine Translation through Q&A Feedback*, **AMTA 2025**
2024/10	*Guiding LLMs to Post-Edit Machine Translation with Error Annotations*, **University of Toronto** (Host: Annie En-Shiun Lee)
2017/10	*Tracing the Roots of Perfectionism*, **TEDxYouth**
2017/03	*A Comparison of Gender-related Adjectives in BNC (English) and koTenTen12 (Korean) using Sketch Engine*, **Charles University**

Poster Presentations

** Excludes conference presentations*

2026/05 *Question Answering-based Machine Translation Evaluation and Its Effect on User Reliance*, AIM Research & Learning Symposium, **University of Maryland**

2026/04 *What Makes Good Multilingual Reasoning? Disentangling Reasoning Traces with Measurable Features & Reheat Nachos for Dinner? Evaluating AI Support for Cross-Cultural Communication of Neologisms*, MASC-ALL 2026, **Howard University**

2026/03 *Multi-Agent Systems for Machine Translation Evaluation and Its Effect on User Reliance*, Capital One Expo, **University of Maryland**

2025/09 *Understanding Trust in Machine Translation (MT): A Language Science Station Study at Planet Word*, Language Science Day, **University of Maryland**

2025/08 *Model Internals Reveal Language Preference in Multilingual RAG*, SCALE 2025, **Johns Hopkins University**

2024/09 *Understanding Trust in Machine Translation (MT): A Language Science Station Study at Planet Word*, Language Science Day, **University of Maryland**

2024/05 *Guiding LLMs to Post-Edit Machine Translation with Error Annotations*, MASC-SLL 2024, **Johns Hopkins University**

Teaching

Fall 2023 Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Data Science (CMSC 320)

Spr. 2022 Student Mentor, Data Science and Artificial Intelligence (GEST 151)

Spr. 2021 Student Mentor, Data Science and Artificial Intelligence (GEST 151)

2021 Lecturer, KUBIG NLP BoostCamp

Academic Advising

2026 Ahmed Haj Ahmed, Undergraduate, Haverford College

2026 Mustafa Rashid, Undergraduate, Haverford College

2026 Varun Nautiyal, Undergraduate, University of Maryland

Media Coverage

2026 The Washington Post, New data shows people are getting personal with AI

2026 MIT Technology Review, We still don't know how people are really using AI

2025 Slator, How Question Answering Can Transform AI Translation Evaluation

2024 Slator, How To Improve Post-Editing Capabilities of Large Language Models

Other Experience

2025/05 – 2026/04 Sub-team Leader, EvalEval Coalition

2022/01 – 2022/06	Team Leader/Staff, Vizable
2020/12 – 2022/07	President, Korea University Data Science Society (KUBIG)

Last updated: October 12, 2026